

2. Analyst interview

Questions are selected from gaps in your proposal. For each material gap, the analyst explains why the information matters. Mark research-needed items when you do not yet have a defensible answer.

Business and market

Business name Required

Why this matters: This identifies the project and appears in its history.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Business model Required

Why this matters: The business model determines which operating and working-capital questions apply.

Choose...

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

What will you sell or provide? Required

Why this matters: The offering determines what costs, capacity, and revenue drivers belong in the model.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Who are your target customers and where will you reach them? Required

Why this matters: The customer and channel help explain the demand basis behind the sales forecast.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

What evidence supports your expected demand? Include source or mark research needed. Required

Why this matters: A forecast without demand evidence is a student estimate, not a validated market result.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Sales, price, and volume

Average realized selling price per unit / service Required

Why this matters: Price is kept separate from units so the model can test a price decision without silently changing volume.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Expected units, customers, or transactions in Year 1 Required

Why this matters: Volume multiplied by price establishes Year 1 revenue and drives variable costs.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Expected annual volume growth after Year 1 (%) Required

Why this matters: The five-year forecast needs an explicit volume path; the analyst will not invent growth.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Direct cost per unit / service Required

Why this matters: Direct cost determines gross profit and changes with units sold.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Staffing and operating costs

Baseline paid employee count Required

Why this matters: A staffing decision needs a baseline workforce and labor-cost context.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Average hourly wage (\$); enter 0 if not applicable Required

Why this matters: Wages and hours determine the labor cost included in operating expenses.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Average paid hours per employee per week Required

Why this matters: Hours convert headcount and wage into annual payroll.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Employer payroll taxes and benefits (%) Required

Why this matters: Employer costs make payroll more complete than wages alone. Research jurisdiction-specific rates if unknown.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Other Year 1 operating expenses, excluding payroll and marketing (\$) Required

Why this matters: Rent, utilities, insurance, and other ongoing expenses affect break-even and cash.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Annual growth in other operating expenses (%) Required

Why this matters: The model needs an explicit cost path across the forecast horizon.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Year 1 marketing budget (\$) Required

Why this matters: Marketing is both an operating expense and a possible driver of the student's demand assumptions.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Startup uses and working capital

Opening inventory at cost (\$) Required

Why this matters: Opening inventory is an asset and a funding use, not an immediate expense.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Target inventory days on hand Required

Why this matters: This estimates the inventory balance needed to support sales and COGS; research supplier lead times if unknown.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Average days to collect customer payments (0 for payment at sale) Required

Why this matters: Collection timing can create a cash shortfall even when sales are profitable.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Average days to pay suppliers (0 for payment at purchase) Required

Why this matters: Supplier payment timing affects cash and payables.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Opening equipment and buildout cost (\$) Required

Why this matters: Long-lived assets affect opening funding, depreciation, investing cash flow, and PP&E.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Other opening uses (\$), excluding inventory, equipment, and prepaids Required

Why this matters: Licenses, legal setup, initial supplies, and other one-time costs increase funding required. Identify them separately so they are not mistaken for recurring expenses.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Opening deposits and prepaids (\$) Required

Why this matters: These are opening assets and funding uses, not ordinary operating expenses.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Pre-opening expenses (\$) Required

Why this matters: Pre-opening expenses use funding and reduce opening retained earnings; they should not be counted as assets.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Annual maintenance / replacement capital spending (\$) Required

Why this matters: Capital spending affects investing cash flow and the PP&E roll-forward.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Average useful life for opening equipment (years) Required

Why this matters: Useful life determines depreciation and ending PP&E.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Other financially material assumptions

Effective income tax rate (%) (research or confirm; enter 0 only if applicable) Required

Why this matters: Taxes affect net income and cash. Use a researched or instructor-provided assumption rather than a guess.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Financing

Identified owner/investor equity available at opening (\$) Required

Why this matters: Only committed or explicitly identified sources count toward funding. The model checks instructor limits.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

If contributions are not equal, list each investor contribution separated by commas (\$)

Why this matters: The applied instructor rules may set a per-investor maximum. Individual amounts are needed when contributions are unequal.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Identified loan funds available at opening (\$); enter 0 if none Required

Why this matters: Only an identified loan counts as a source. Permitted borrowing is not an automatic source.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Identified opening debt type Required

Why this matters: Instructor-configured borrowing rates apply only to identified debt; they do not fill a funding gap.

Choose...

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Annual principal repayment (\$); enter 0 if none Required

Why this matters: Repayment affects financing cash flow and the ending debt balance.

Information source

[Student assumption](#)



Source / URL / document reference, if researched

☐ I need to research this

Back to plan

Create structured baseline

Business Development History

Version 1 records the initial baseline. Each accepted decision creates a new immutable model version. Rejected proposals remain in the history without changing approved results.

Version 1 will appear here after the baseline is calculated.